Data-driven Cold Email Copywriting

How to write killer-copy for cold outreach without being an expert or paying for a $799 course from a guru.



by Mitchell Keller

The 3 things that will destroy your copy before you ever hit send.

Bad Lead Lists

- inaccurate data
- Picking the wrong intent data for your offer
- Hitting as many job titles as you possibly can
- Not thinking about how your copy should change based on the person - rather than the company
- Creating lead lists only at the company level - not sniffing problems.

The impact?
Great copy to a bad list does nothing. Because if the copy isn't relevant to the individual they don't care - but it's worse than this. Often it ends up very 'ME' focused.

No Relevant/Valid Reason For Reaching Out

The impact?
A great offer that isn't relevant is automatically a trash offer

Using "Fluffy" personalization

- I love your blank
- I live in blank too
- nice post about blank
- Omg you surf?

This stuff worked in the past - in fact one of my best campaigns involved making a simple callout about an obscure restuarant or landmark near that person's location using AI.

The impact?

A compliment followed by sales pitch - unless it's legit 100% from the bottom of your heart is gonna be shite.
Bonus: Templates are meaningless - the structure and quality of the copy is the 20% of the performance - let's focus on the 80.

The truth is all of these problems really just stem from the lead list. The lead list knows all.

We want good data so we don't have to be good writers

Have you ever heard anything like the following:

Your offer is too general
We aren't that type of business
We don't have X position on our team
We don't use that software anymore
Our website load speed is actually low
We are already crushing it with X
We don't even use that tool

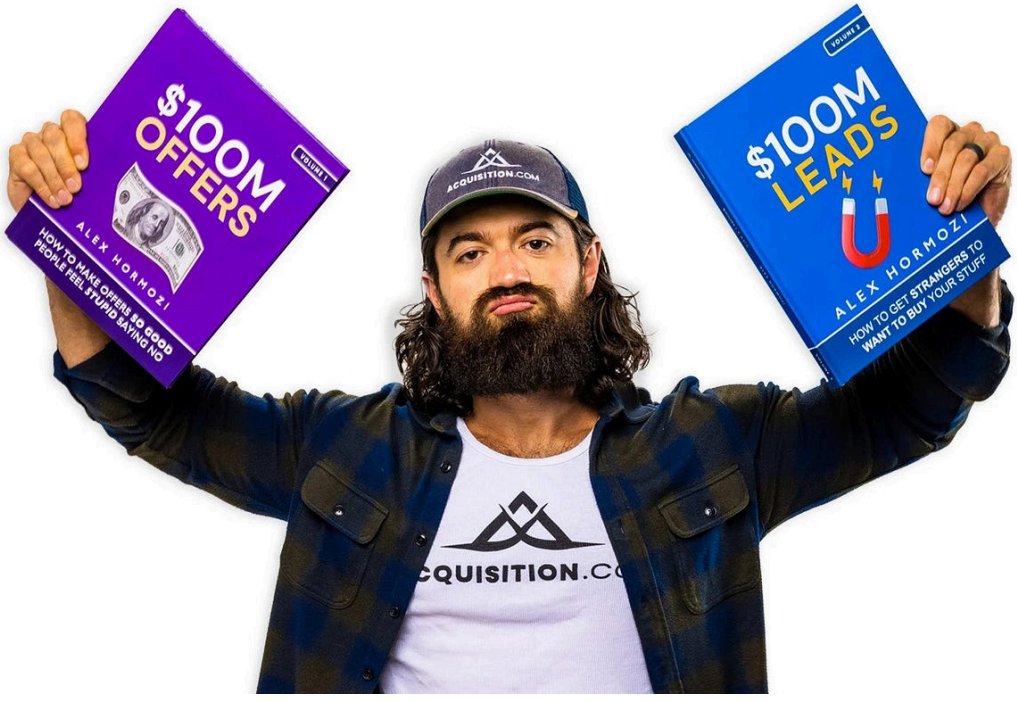
But often times the real impact is that you'll hear nothing at all with your campaigns - which is arguably worse.

This is cause data breeds relevance - without relevance people just don't care - so the wrong data = irrelevant campaigns.

The 4 Main Questions you need to answer for clean copy - Prior to even pulling a list.

1. Why are you contacting them?
2. Why are you contacting them now?
   *combined points 1 and 2 = **your angle** - more on this shortly

3. What is in it for them? at every moment of your copy you should be either providing value or peaking curiousity.
4. How often are these people being outreached to?



The harder the lead is to find the better the result.
50% of your campaigns will start with an Angle and the other 50% will start with an offer or lead magnet.

Heuristic: every great campaign starts with a great list and a great idea and builds from there. Get creative.



Taking copy to the next level

- 1 specific angle (to answer the Why you, Why Now question)
- Praying on pain points specific to the individual (To build emotion if they have this pain point)
- Providing a relevent lead magnet / offer (To solve the potential problem)
  - It needs to make them money, save them money or save them time. The way you present this depends on industry AND PERSON.
- A frictionless CTA that provides a tangible benefit
- Triggers that show you care, narrow the lead list even further OR personalize the **offer by handling possible objections.**
- Bonus: Relevant social proof where it matters

Hint: sometimes social proof aka a case study can answer the 3 main questions itself.

⚠️ Warning you gotta know your mfin industry - if you don't you're doomed.

How do we compile everything we need for great copy? Research and Preparation. AKA how you source the list.



The art of war. - "Every Battle is Won before it is fought"

Rules to follow

- Every lead list should have 1 angle
- Every lead list should hone in on a few specific job titles facing a potential problem
- Lead lists should be segmented by company size - the size of the company changes who will be responsbile for the pain points you're trying to fix and the way you present the value prop
- Your lead magnet should be a precursor to you main service
- Don't pitch the whole service in the offering instead focus on pitching one small fix to a major problem.

'Angle' Examples to get you thinking like a true Lead GENeral

1. Your prospect is actively hiring a particular position
2. They mention something in their job posts keywords that is relevant to your offer (remote)
3. They use a technology that is integral to your service - Maybe you only help Hubspot businesses
4. They are likely using a competitors tool
5. They have a certain number of a specific positions on the team
6. they have certain number of people in a department
7. They have specific revenue range
8. They operate in a certain location
9. They provide a particular service
10. They have a specific range of website visitors
11. They run a business type that could benefit from indexing TONs of pages
12. They are or are not running ads on a certain platform
13. Specific info in their reviews on a certain website
14. recently funded by a certain entity (Y combinator)
15. Recently attended an in person conference
16. Currently in a niche group on Linkedin or FB
17. Recently interacted with your lead magnet post on social media
18. They recently raised funding
19. People who recently changed job positions

And the list goes on.

Here's the thing though, some of these things can be triggers as well.

For instance - knowing they use salesforce + convertkit + actively hiring SDR + over 5000 website visitors = maybe they have good lead flow = maybe you help them take form fills on website and filter them into only ICP contacts that enrich straight into CRM so their SDRs get onboarded.

Copy might look something like this:

Name - Saw you're hiring {job-title} on linkedin right now and thought it might make sense to reach out.

Wondering if you're doing anything to decrease the amount of some your SDRs are spending on qualified leads?

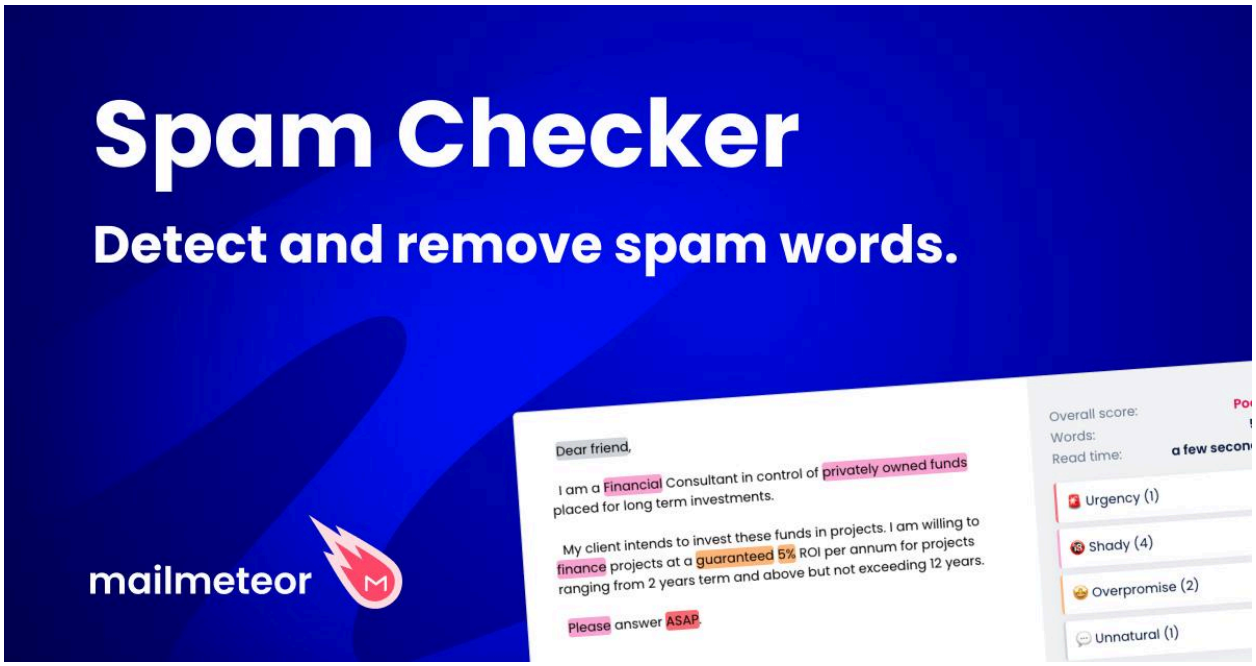
Put together a system to take your engaged leads from convert kit, score them based on ICP and automatically add them to Salesforce for {{SDR Full Name}} in 15 minutes so they can start hitting quarterly quota.

Can I send you a short video showing you exactly how it works?

Then Spintax the shit out of it.

TIP use GPT or claude to generate your spintax

Then take your new copy and throw it into mailmeteors.com's spam checker to filter out and replace spam words.



mailmeteor
Spam Checker: Write Better Email Messages
Free tool to check spam trigger words in your email message. A quick and easy way to write better emails and avoid landing in spam.

This will help you hit primary inbox which is the first and most important step of all outreach.

Does size matter?

Short copy - long copy So what should you do?



Both.
Always try both - Sometimes 1 sentence campaigns absolutely rip. Sometimes your lead magnet is so damn good that's all you have to send and the rest can be accomplished through the sales process.

Other times you really need to dig deep with the prospect.

Show you've done your research - prove your competence.

Do 2 angles 1 that's long and drawn out and one that's extremely short and value based

But EOD always cut the fat and keep things simple

Don't use your jargon only use jargon related to their industry.

GPT can help and as hormozi always says ensure it's at a 5th grade level max.

So what makes great copy?

1. It all starts with a great lead list that goes beyond the business down to indivual needs - I recommend starting with Niche LinkedIn groups and scoring leads from there.
2. Understanding your market
3. Using data as your ally to address pain points and personalize the offer
4. A kick ass lead magnet
5. A simple CTA
6. Programmatic testing - don't give up after 1 campaign.
7. Write at a 5th grade level.

Formats to try

Call out problem
Personalized solution
Case study
CTA

Demand Gen vs Demand Capture

Eric Nowoslawski has a great video that breaks down the difference between them in depth.

Here's a quick summary

Demand Gen: This is outreach that creates NEW interest around a problem by using a novel approach.

How I perceive it in practice: Using a truly no-brainer lead magnet to generate interest and pipeline.

Reframing the problem in a new way that truly hones in on pain points - novel angle. (in-person events)

in lead gen last month it was hey i found a way to take all your website visitors find their linkedins and score them based on your ICP so you can recapture bounced visitors.

Demand Capture:
This is capturing pre-existing demand. Meaning you're capturing anyone that woke up and was like damn I really need SEO right now - I gotta fix this problem. Just looking for people that have a problem right now and want to fix it.

Example - real estate bilboards. 99.9% are not in the real estate market rn - they want the .1% that are.

How I percieve it in practice: This is sending an offer and hammering case studies. It's sort of saying look, do you want this right now? no? okay I'll be back around in 2-3 months.

Sometimes it comes down to the industry - for the most part design is a demand capture for instance - but there's ways to make it a demand gen offer - for instance CRO can be demand gen depending on it's framing.

In practice I think demand capture offers are often about using longer copy - your goal is not to convince that they need this service. You're more so saying - if you need this right now here's why we are the guys for the job.

Where as demand generation is saying hey idk if you need this but this is literally so cool or so valuable it's gotta be a no brainer you to check it out.

Each offer can have both realistically.

Think of a way you can have both.